for one thing.

The girls were going to have to bring in samples of urine—their own, of course—on which they would then run tests. Walker warned me, however, that I must ask those young women who were menstruating not to bring in their own urine, but to use their neighbor's.

I stared at Walker with horror. I was on difficult enough terms with the girls, as it was, since, as their instructor, I had to curb my naturally flirtatious tendencies, and that reduced me to melancholia. I didn't see how I could get this stuff about menstruation across to them.

I said, "How do I tell them that, Dr. Walker?"

He said, "With your mouth," and walked away.

So I did and the young women took it very calmly indeed. I guess menstruation was old stuff to them.

22

On December 16, 1953, a gentleman from Metropolitan Life Insurance Company arrived with a check for $1,007.90 It represented the twenty-year-old annuity policy my father had opened on my behalf when I was thirteen, in lieu of an allowance for me. I had been paying the premiums myself since 1942, of course. Now that I had the cash worth of the policy, I didn't need it. I'd rather have had the allowance when I was young—but who can forsee the future, and my father had meant well.

2 3

Suddenly I was having a rash of rejections. Lucky Starr and the Oceans of Venus, the third of my Paul French series, was encountering serious objections at Doubleday—the first that had developed over those novels.

On the whole, Doubleday was justified, for Lucky Starr, in this particular adventure, was needlessly close-mouthed, allowing his sidekick to think he was an utter bastard, when I was merely trying to keep things from the reader. I had to rewrite in such a way as to keep things from the reader in a subtler fashion and more in keeping with Lucky's character.

"The Singing Bell" was rejected not only by Ellery Queen, but also by Astounding. Fred Pohl, who was now working with Ballantine, rejected it for